

Session 1: Our Place in the Universe

Key Takeaways

- It is helpful to be aware of our own assumptions and questions and pay attention to the intent of the biblical authors.
- These early chapters of Genesis form the introduction to the Hebrew Bible. The biblical authors crafted these stories to set the tone and expectations for what will come next.

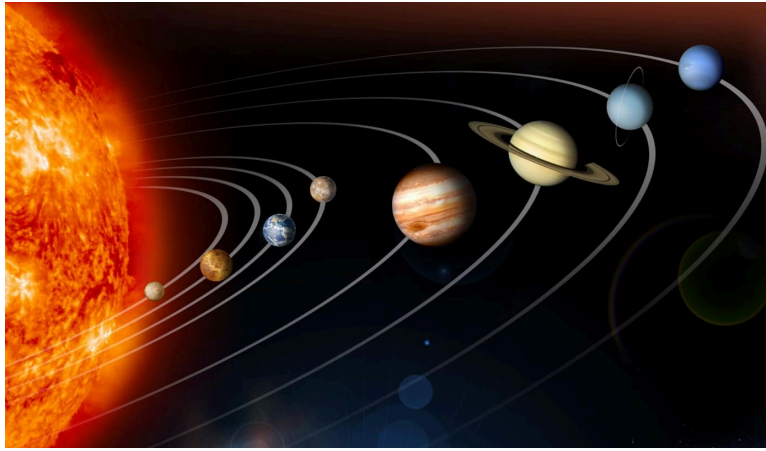
A Modern View of the Cosmos

Many of us have probably encountered satellite photos or pictures of planet Earth, the solar system, the Milky Way galaxy, or perhaps even other galaxies and other celestial bodies. This view of our cosmos affects the way that we interact with Scripture. The first step to understanding the biblical authors' view of the cosmos is to start with our own understanding of the cosmos.



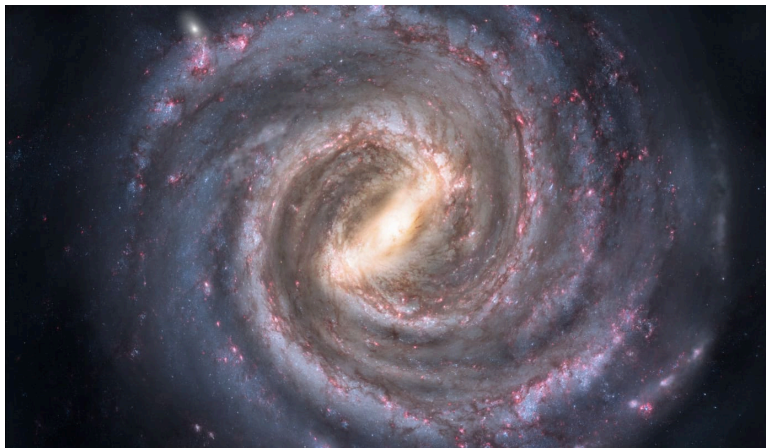
Stockli, Reto (2000). [NASA](#)

A satellite photo of planet Earth with the Moon in the background.



NASA/JPL (2009). [NASA](#)

A rendering of the solar system.



Risinger, Nick (2009). [Wikimedia Commons](#)

A picture of our location in the Milky Way galaxy.



Hubble Telescope (2009). *Hubble Deep Field Image*. [Wikimedia Commons](#).

A photo from the Hubble Telescope of the deep field of space, displaying a variety of galaxies in the universe.

We all have an essential view of the universe—how it was formed and our place in it. And intentionally or unintentionally, these views shape how we read the Bible. It is helpful to be aware of our preconceived assumptions as we approach Scripture.

Reflection Question

What experiences have shaped your view of the cosmos? How has that affected your faith or understanding of the Bible?